

Chapter 79 - Dilemma

Yan Lin finished making her will under her private lawyer's puzzled gaze. Actually, there wasn't anything particularly special about it - after her death, part of her private assets would be donated to domestic charity funds, and another part would anonymously fund some overseas rose cultivation bases¹.

She and Feng Yue had no children, so there was no question of leaving inheritance to descendants.

Her only concern was whether her parents and Feng Yue's parents could accept both of them dying together.

But these were all worst-case scenarios. Yan Lin believed that this time she would definitely not let Feng Yue repeat her tragic fate, and she wouldn't just sit idle and wait for death.

A few days later, Yan Lin arrived early in the morning with prepared gifts and rang the doorbell at Miller's house.

It was the weekend and the weather was quite nice. Feng Yue's whole family was at home, and they were preparing to have a barbecue party in their backyard.

So when Yan Lin stood outside the yard and rang the doorbell, the first person to discover her wasn't anyone else, but Jiang Ming, who had been dead drunk that night.

As soon as Jiang Ming saw her, her eyes narrowed and she looked very unfriendly.

"Who are you looking for?" Jiang Ming put down the yard cleaning tools in her hands and asked unceremoniously.

Yan Lin's expression remained unchanged. "Hello, I'm here to visit Aunt Jiang Shu and Uncle Feng Hehai. My name is Yan Lin."

Jiang Ming naturally knew her name, but the other party wasn't here to find Feng Yue, but to visit the elders. This way, Jiang Ming couldn't just drive her away, nor did she have reason to refuse to receive her aunt and uncle's guest.

Jiang Ming was so angry she ground her teeth, but fortunately Jiang Zhao came out at this time and welcomed Yan Lin in.

Jiang Zhao had seen Yan Lin that night. Although due to the darkness he hadn't seen clearly or remembered who the other person was at the time, when he saw her now, he understood everything.

Jiang Zhao asked Yan Lin to sit in the living room and wait for a while. Feng Yue and several elders had gone out to buy ingredients and weren't home temporarily.

Then Jiang Zhao poured tea for Yan Lin, and only after finishing all this did he return to the yard.

Jiang Ming watched Jiang Zhao both invite the person in and pour tea for her, and was simply livid.

"Hey! Do you know who she is? You not only let her in but also poured tea for her! If Xiao Yue comes back and sees her, won't she be furious!" Jiang Ming was huffing angrily, no longer bothering to clean, just sitting there sulking.

Jiang Zhao sighed helplessly. "Catherine, Xiao Yue has already seen her. Otherwise, how do you think Xiao Yue carried you out of the bar that night?"

Hearing this, Jiang Ming blinked blankly. "You mean Xiao Yue already knew she followed her to Vancouver? But haven't they already divorced?"

"So what if they're divorced? Even people who break up can get back together, so naturally divorced people can remarry too."

Jiang Ming opened her mouth to say something, but suddenly remembered Feng Yue's resistance when she had previously wanted to introduce someone to her.

So... Xiao Yue still likes this person in her heart?

Jiang Zhao watched Jiang Ming fall into deep thought, silently shook his head, and began cleaning by himself.

Although he and Jiang Ming were fraternal twins, sometimes he couldn't figure out what his sister was thinking.

Yan Lin sat in the living room for a while, feeling somewhat nervous. On the surface she appeared calm as still water, but inside she was actually very tense.

Yan Lin looked at the time - she had already been sitting here for five minutes. She thought for a moment, then stood up and walked toward the yard.

The Jiang Zhao and Jiang Ming siblings were arranging tables and chairs and preparing the barbecue grill. When both saw her, they stopped what they were doing.

Yan Lin's expression didn't change. "I'll come out and help."

Yan Lin was nominally still a guest, and Jiang Zhao was about to politely refuse when he heard Jiang Ming's voice: "Great, then you can assemble the barbecue grill."

Speaking thus, Jiang Ming held the manual written entirely in English and stepped back, making space for her.

Jiang Zhao was about to scold Jiang Ming a few words when he saw Yan Lin had already rolled up her sleeves and walked over.

Jiang Zhao: ...

Jiang Ming had been fiddling with the instruction manual for ages without even assembling a single support frame, so she handed the entire barbecue grill assembly task to Yan Lin and pulled Jiang Zhao aside to catch their breath.

"She's still a guest after all. How can we have guests do manual work?"

"So what? If she wants to pursue Xiao Yue, she needs to show some sincerity. If she's still as high and mighty as when she married Xiao Yue, who would want to be with her?"

Jiang Ming didn't deliberately avoid Yan Lin when speaking, so she heard every word clearly.

When she heard Jiang Ming say she was "high and mighty," Yan Lin's hand paused while flipping through the instruction manual.

Jiang Ming wasn't wrong. That's exactly how she used to be - high and mighty. She thought agreeing to marriage was fulfilling Feng Yue's request, not realizing that deep in her heart, she too yearned to have a legal partnership with Feng Yue.

Her past self had been blinded by a single leaf², unable to see her own heart clearly. Her present self was here to make up for those deficiencies.

The tasks Jiang Ming was making her do weren't really that difficult for her - they were nothing at all.

Jiang Zhao was still protective at heart. After hearing Jiang Ming's words, he also felt Yan Lin should pay some price, so he no longer stopped Jiang Ming.

Thus, when the shopping expedition returned, they saw Jiang Ming standing in the yard with her hands on her hips, ordering someone around.

Feng Yue sat in the passenger seat, looking at that all-too-familiar figure in the yard, and fell into silence.

Yan Lin saw a car enter the garage, and soon Feng Yue appeared in the yard carrying two shopping bags, followed by the Jiang Shu and Feng Hehai couple.

Yan Lin wanted to approach and say a few words to Feng Yue, but Jiang Ming was faster and pulled her away first. Before leaving, she said to Jiang Shu and Feng Hehai: "Aunt and Uncle, this is a guest who came to visit you."

Yan Lin had no choice but to greet the Jiang Shu couple first.

The couple was also surprised by Yan Lin's appearance, but since she was a guest, they couldn't not receive her.

Only then did Yan Lin escape from Jiang Ming's enslavement.

Jiang Ming pulled Feng Yue to a corner, and only then did Feng Yue ask: "Cousin... how did she come here?"

Seeing her expression was normal, Jiang Ming told Feng Yue about Yan Lin coming to visit early in the morning.

Feng Yue listened quietly, not saying a word from beginning to end, looking as if she didn't care at all about Yan Lin's arrival.

Seeing this, Jiang Ming asked the question that had been puzzling her: "Xiao Yue, she... is pursuing you, isn't she?"

Hearing this, Feng Yue was stunned for a moment, then smiled, though the smile didn't reach her eyes. "But we're already divorced."

Feng Yue said this decisively, as if speaking to Jiang Ming, but also as if speaking to herself.

After speaking, Feng Yue left with the excuse of needing to process ingredients in the kitchen. Jiang Ming watched her back and vaguely confirmed some things in her heart.

Feng Yue hadn't not known the answer to the question just now - she just didn't dare say the answer.

She was perfectly clear in her heart about what feelings Yan Lin had for her, but she just didn't dare acknowledge it.

And that Yan Lin could push someone to this extent showed just how deep the harm she had caused Feng Yue was.

Jiang Shu and Feng Hehai brought Feng Yue into the house, and only then did Yan Lin have the opportunity to give her prepared gifts to the two.

Besides the Jiang Shu couple, Yan Lin had also prepared gifts for uncle and aunt, grandfather and grandmother, and even the Jiang Zhao and Jiang Ming siblings.

Yan Lin's etiquette was impeccable, and Jiang Shu couldn't very well send her home, so naturally, Yan Lin joined their barbecue party.

However, Jiang Ming still deliberately kept her and Feng Yue separated - Feng Yue was always busy in the kitchen, while she stayed in the yard helping Jiang Ming.

Jiang Pingrui and Miller came back later with the two elderly people, and when they saw Yan Lin busy in the yard, they were also stunned for a few seconds.

Feng Yue's grandfather was a little old man with a bad temper, so as soon as he saw Yan Lin, his face darkened.

Yan Lin still properly greeted the old man: "Grandfather."

"Who's your grandfather! You divorced our Nuannuan³ long ago. I can't bear this title of grandfather from you!" The old man's face was ugly as he walked toward the house.

Actually, before the two divorced, the old man had really liked this child Yan Lin. Yan Lin was smart and didn't talk much, and every time she came to see him, she would play chess with him for an entire afternoon.

But ever since learning why the two divorced, the old man's fondness for Yan Lin had turned into resentment.

Although Jiang Ming was pleased to see this, she was also afraid the old man might anger himself to illness, so she quickly went to the old man's side to coax him with sweet words.

Jiang Ming left with the old man, and Jiang Zhao took over the task of "ordering around" Yan Lin. However, regarding Jiang Ming's strict vigilance, Jiang Zhao still hoped adults could communicate more.

So Yan Lin was sent by Jiang Zhao to help wash dishes in the kitchen.

Seeing that there were just the two of them in the kitchen, Yan Lin finally found a chance to speak with Feng Yue.

"Ah Yue, have you been feeling unwell anywhere recently?"

What answered Yan Lin was endless silence.

Feng Yue concentrated on frying chicken wings, the oil pot bubbling "gulu gulu," the sound spreading through the quiet kitchen.

Unable to get a response from the other party, Yan Lin could only talk about other things on her own.

"What I said before was definitely not just casual talk. I know you're hiding things from me, and it's understandable that you don't trust me. But I will definitely save you, so I want to ask you to please not give up on yourself."

"At any time, don't give up hope of living, whether for me..." Yan Lin paused here, "whether for your family or for yourself, don't give up the thought of living."

In the kitchen, there was only Yan Lin's voice, accompanied by the sounds of the oil pot and running water. Yan Lin's tone was like she was describing something perfectly ordinary, but every sentence was full of encouragement.

Feng Yue still stood there quietly, her eyes staring directly at the chicken wings tumbling in the oil pot.

But if you looked carefully, you'd find that the chicken wings in the pot already showed signs of burning, and Feng Yue's eyes weren't focused on the bubbling oil at all.

She wasn't as calm as she appeared to be.

Footnotes:

¹ Rose cultivation bases (月季培育基地): This refers to Yan Lin's love for roses, particularly as they relate to Feng Yue. "Yue" (月) in Feng Yue's name can mean "moon" but is also part of the word for rose (月季).

² Blinded by a single leaf (一叶障目): A Chinese idiom meaning to be unable to see the big picture because of minor issues - like having one's vision blocked by a single leaf so you can't see the forest.

³ Nuannuan (囡囡): A term of endearment meaning "little girl" or "baby girl," used by the grandfather for Feng Yue.